

It doesn't take much searching to find women with stories of friends or relatives who have been financially ruined by a divorce or who've stayed in a bad relationship because of finances.

The only way to make sure we don't end up stuck in a situation that doesn't serve us is through being financially free.

This was my biggest 'why' behind making sure I had the tools to be financially free. Like that aunty at the party, I wanted to be able to say no. Growing up with such strong ideologies around me, I never wanted to be in a situation where I couldn't leave because I didn't have the financial means to. Having an emergency fund and investments that bring you income when you can't work are vital tools for women — for anyone, really — to live their life on their own terms.

I like to call it f*** you money. Investing allows us to have f*** you money. Nothing compares to knowing that you 'got you' for the rest of your life, and that your life going forward will be on your own terms. Investing for yourself is investing in your own freedom and choices.

This book isn't going to teach you how to become rich quickly, but it will teach you how to grow wealth like generations of families have before us. It'll show you the strategies we were never taught, decode the language we never learned, and walk you step by step through how to grow a stock market portfolio like a professional, so that you can reap the rewards of financial independence and create generational wealth.

There are many concepts you'll find throughout this book where you'll realise it's not nearly as complicated as it's seemed. It's not 20 layers deep, with lots of intricacies and nuances that the average investor needs to know. One may never know everything when it comes to the stock market, as it is constantly evolving, but once you know enough through this book, you'll have the tools you need to get started.

Let's begin.